

such issues are still prevalent despite the fact that most of these things i.e. the CPU cooler and cases are standardised. Manufacturers often deviate from the standards for the sake of innovating new products. Let's break the choice of cabinets down into three categories to make things simpler. We'll look at what kind of cabinet you'll require based on whether you're getting an air cooler, closed loop liquid cooler or a custom liquid cooling loop.

Air cooler

Buying a cabinet for your air-cooler is the simplest process. You'll first have to figure out what kind of cooler is best for your CPU and then make a list of options. You should ideally have 3-4 different options based on form factor. Don't be under the impression that small coolers are underpowered. There are some really decent low-profile coolers which can give bigger coolers a run for their money. Noctua has a couple of such coolers which compete with full-fledged coolers.

If you're going for a mini-ITX form factor motherboard, then do note the position of the RAM slots from the CPU socket. If the RAM slots are too close then you have reduced clearance for some of the medium-sized coolers and you're stuck with using just the low-profile coolers. And even then, you need to worry about the orientation



DAN Case A4-SFX v2

of the cooler. If orienting it in a certain manner makes it difficult to insert another component then you have to stick with a stock cooler or a cooler with an even more reduced profile.

Coming back to the cabinet, one of the problems with small form-factor cabinets is that there will be a lot of support structures jutting out from odd places. Check the image of the DAN Case A4-SFX v2. The motherboard mount ensures that the cooler is facing the side and barely has any space along the Z-axis (height) of the cooler, but there's plenty of space along the x-axis and y-axis of the cooler. So the Noctua NH-L12S fits wonderfully.

However, there are also cases such as the Lian Li PC-Q05 which requires a custom cooling solution altogether and that's generally provided with the